

Where should Gujarat invest ₹6,500 crore in tourism?

An evidence-based allocation for economic growth, jobs, regional inclusion and sustainability.

₹6,500 cr

budget

33

districts

4

objectives

~143k

jobs modelled

THE OPPORTUNITY GAP

Follow the gap, not the crowd

3

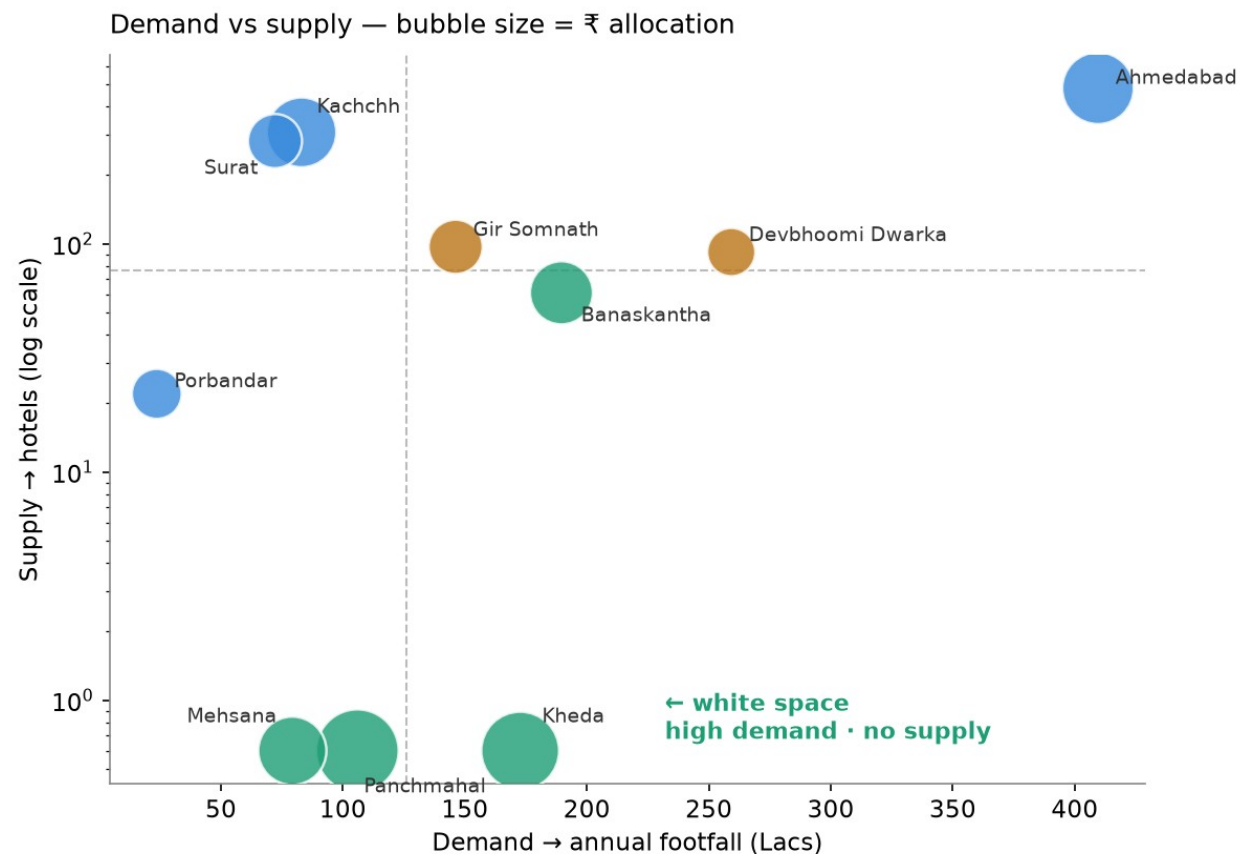
of the top-10 footfall districts have **zero hotels in the data** — a **literal blank canvas**.

310,000

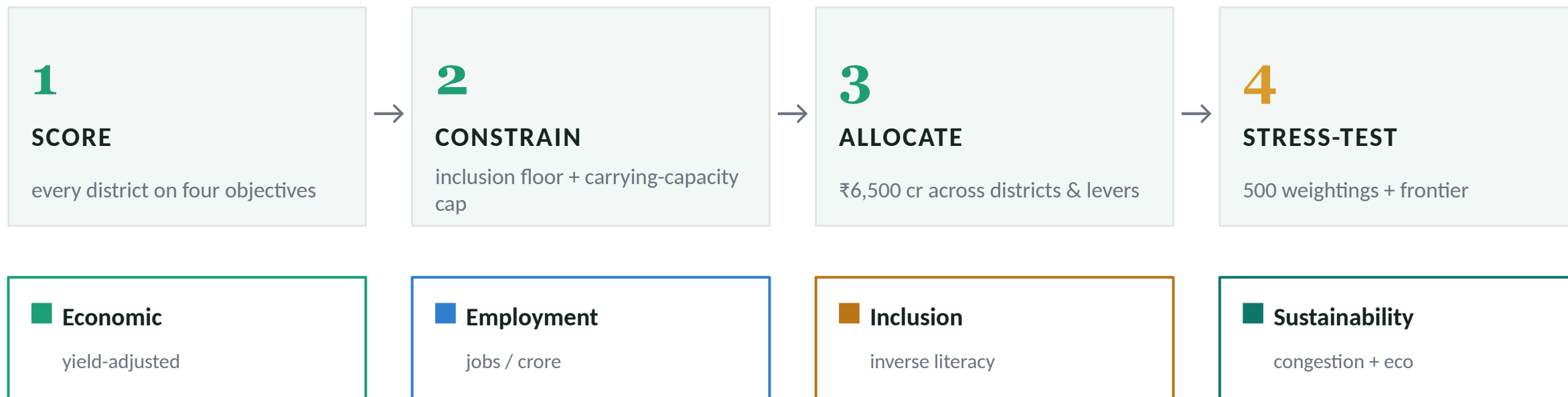
visits per hotel in Banaskantha (Ambaji) — **the state's least-literate district**.

−0.25

correlation of footfall with hotel quality — **the busiest hubs deliver the worst experience**.



PRAVAAH — a transparent allocation engine



Four objectives, scored at step 1 — every parameter cited and tunable. No black box.

THE RECOMMENDATION

Three moves, four levers

BUILD THE WHITE SPACE

₹2.3k cr

Panchmahal, Kheda, Mehsana — new capacity + connectivity where demand has no supply.

LIFT THE LEFT-BEHIND

₹1.0k cr

Banaskantha & Dahod — inclusive flagship: skilling, decongest Ambaji, raise quality.

PROTECT & DISPERSE

₹0.7k cr

Dwarka & Gir Somnath — cap new build in eco-zones, spread visitors, manage carrying capacity.

Across four levers:

■ **₹2,122 cr**
Build

■ **₹1,685 cr**
Upgrade

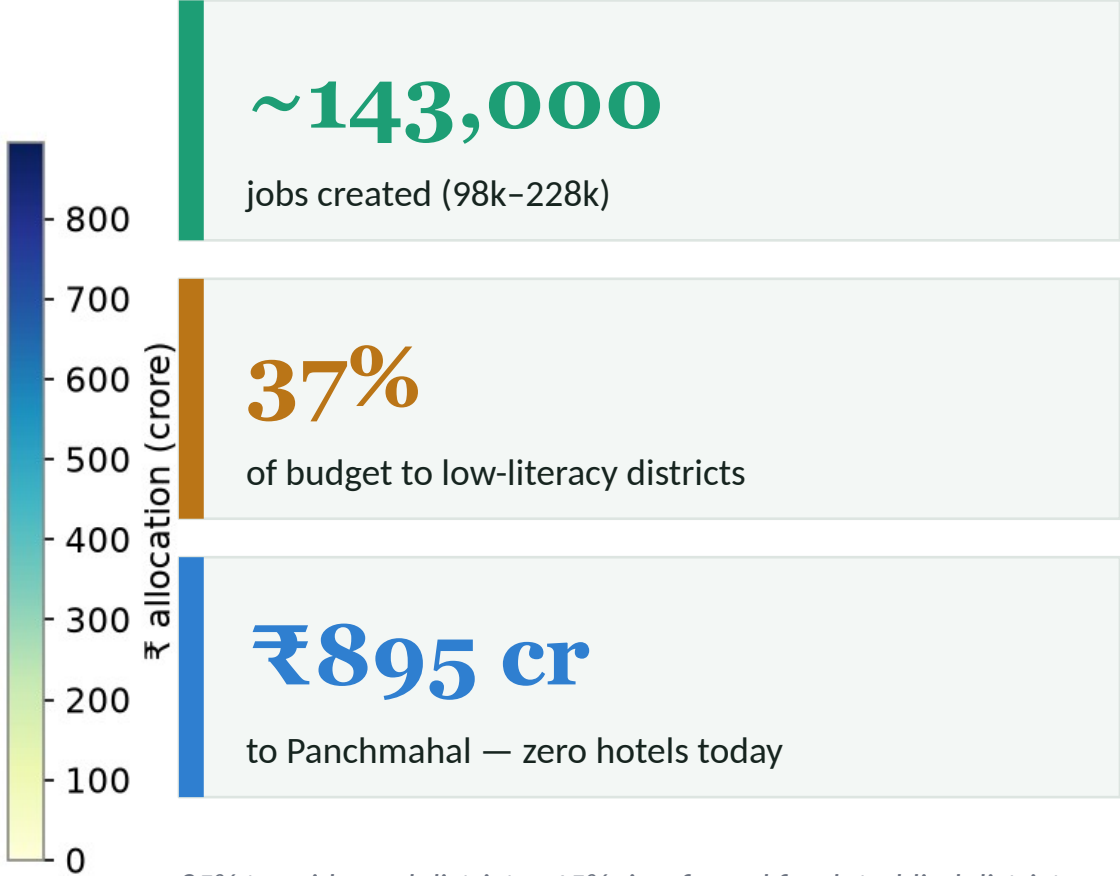
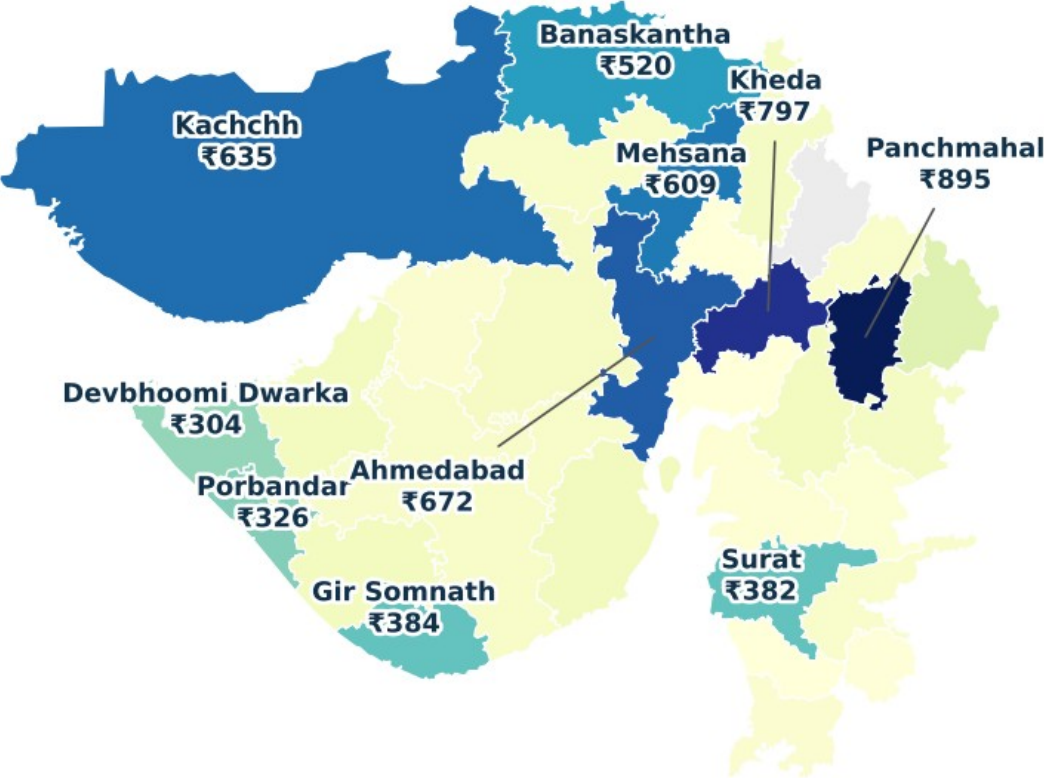
■ **₹1,500 cr**
Protect & disperse

■ **₹1,194 cr**
Skilling & sustainability

GEOGRAPHIC ALLOCATION

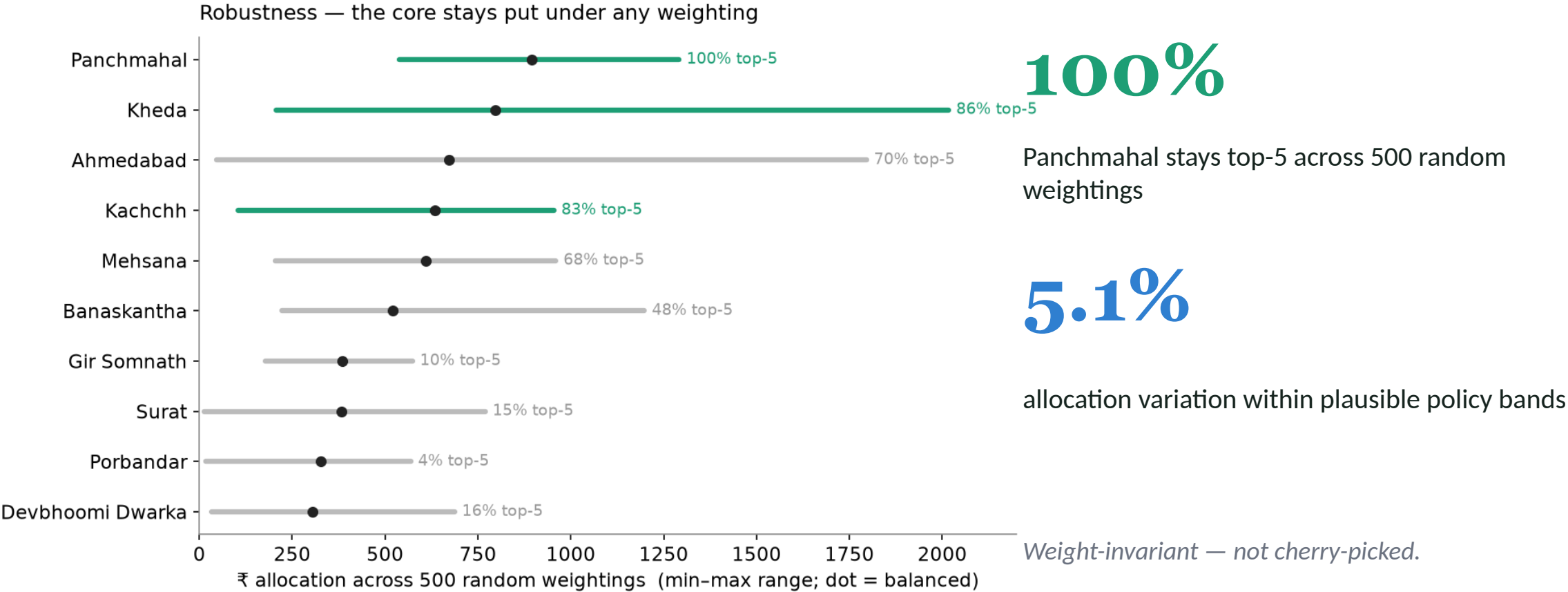
₹6,500 crore, on the map

Where the ₹6,500 cr lands — district allocation



85% to evidenced districts • 15% ring-fenced for data-blind districts.

The recommendation holds under any weighting



A phased plan for inclusive growth

NOW — 18 mo

Quick wins

Quality upgrades in Ahmedabad & Surat;
decongest Ambaji & Dwarka.

18 — 48 mo

Build the white space

Capacity + connectivity in Panchmahal, Kheda,
Mehsana.

4 — 7 yr

Scale & explore

Activate data-blind districts; monitor carrying
capacity.

~143k

jobs created

37%

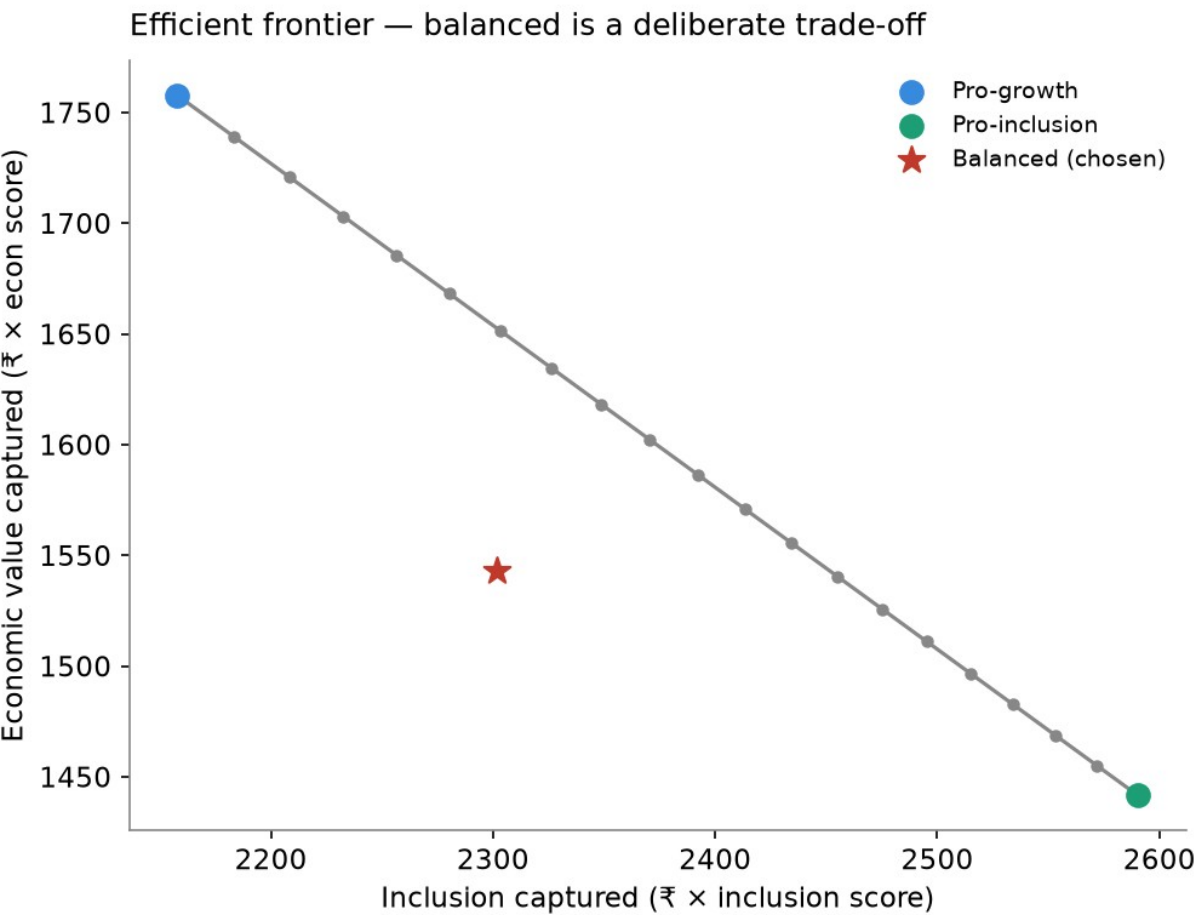
to low-literacy districts

100%

eco-capped, weight-tested

Transform data into decisions that create meaningful impact.

Efficient frontier & model assumptions



Why balanced? The frontier maps the economic-inclusion trade-off; balanced (red star) is a deliberate, defensible compromise — not a corner solution.

- Employment: 22 jobs / ₹cr central, 15–35 range (WTTC India 2024: 46.5M jobs / ₹21tn).
- Yield: relative spend tiers — pilgrimage ₹800 → eco-premium ₹6,000 (the footfall ≠ value fix).
- Inclusion: 2011 Census literacy (relative ranking); 30% floor to bottom-quartile districts.
- Sustainability: congestion (visits / hotel) + Gujarat's six notified Eco-Sensitive Zones.
- Budget split: 85% evidenced (footfall) / 15% exploration (22 data-blind districts).

References & data sources

Competition datasets — QUB GIFT City Datathon 2026

- Hotel & accommodation dataset
- Gujarat tourism statistics (orig. Commissioner of Tourism, Gujarat)
- Gujarat census dataset

Geospatial

- Gujarat district GeoJSON — india-maps-data (Survey of India base)

Government & institutional sources

- Ministry of Tourism, Govt. of India — India Tourism Statistics
- World Travel & Tourism Council (WTTC) — Economic Impact Report 2024
- Tourism Satellite Account (TSA) of India
- Census of India 2011
- Eco-Sensitive Zone notifications — MoEFCC / Gujarat Forest Dept.

All sources listed were directly used in the analysis. No other datasets were incorporated.

Tools & technologies

Analytics & modelling

Python · Pandas · NumPy · openpyxl

Visualisation

Matplotlib

Geospatial analysis

GeoPandas · Shapely · GeoJSON

Presentation development

PptxGenJS · python-pptx

Robustness testing

Monte Carlo simulation (Dirichlet weight sampling)

Framework

PRAVAAH allocation framework

Project resources & validation. Public government and institutional reports (Ministry of Tourism, WTTC, India TSA, Census 2011) were used to harden the model's assumptions. Literature-informed multipliers — tourism jobs-per-crore and spend-per-visit by segment — were sensitivity-tested across documented ranges, not fixed at single values. Generative AI tools were used to accelerate coding and presentation development; all analyses, assumptions, validation, and recommendations were reviewed and verified by the team.